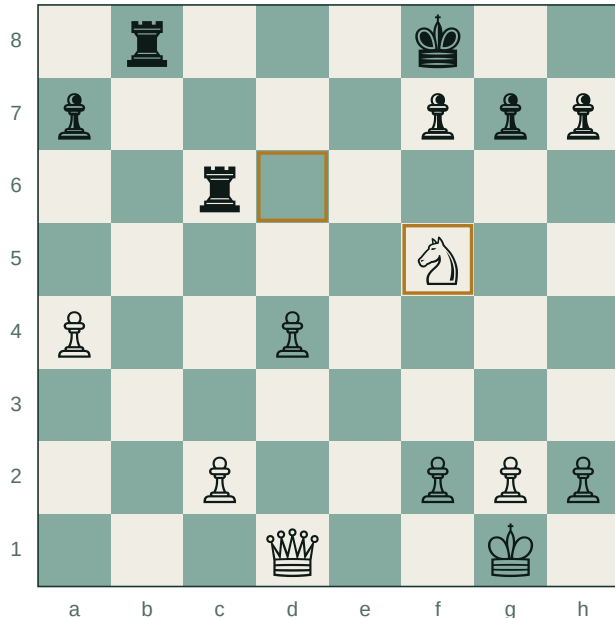


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 23

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Nf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Rcb6 24. Kf1 Rb1 25. Qxb1 Rxb1+

23...Rcb6 The rook moves from c6 to b6. Recorded reply: **24.Kf1**.

24...Rb1 The rook moves from b6 to b1. Recorded reply: **25.Qxb1**.

25...Rxb1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the queen on b1.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on f5 and queen on d1. Check for tactical protection.